FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-32-17018

Issue Title : Nose Gear Tire Damage due to Scrubbing

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3245-21	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737NG, 737	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/11/2017	05/11/2017	04/24/2017

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Applicability

All 737MAX airplanes.

Description

Several 737 operators have reported tire tread damage on their nose gear tires. The damage consists of scrapes and abrasions on the outboard shoulder of the tire. The damage is not localized and instead is consistent around the full 360 degrees of the tire. Tires with this damage are shown in the attached photos.

One 737NG operator who has performed some Engine Out Taxi (EOT) testing reported that certain EOT techniques may aggravate nose tire scrubbing damage since the yaw caused by EOT must be counteracted by the nose tires. EOT is sometimes referred to as "Single Engine Taxi."

Status

Closed.

Interim Action

None

Final Action

The damage shown in the attached photos is the result of overly aggressive nose wheel steering during taxi, while turning off of the runway, or during sharp turns at the gate.

It is remotely possible that this damage can be caused by hard or otherwise faulty rubber in the tire tread. If operators are concerned that the tire may be faulty, they should ask their tire supplier to perform an analysis of the damaged tire.

However, it is our experience that this damage can be seen on new tires, retreaded tires, and on tires made by various manufacturers. As a result, we believe that the cause of the damage is usually operational in nature.

Operator Action

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NOSE WHEEL STEERING OPERATIONAL SUGGESTIONS

Section 2 of the 737MAX Flight Crew Training Manual (FCTM) contains information about taxi speeds and speeds at which to use nose wheel steering. Typical FCTM wording is as follows:

"...The airplane may appear to be moving slower than it actually is due to the flight deck height above the ground. Consequently, the tendency may be to taxi faster than desired. This is especially true during runway turnoff after landing. The ground speed display on the flight instruments may be used to determine actual taxi speed. The appropriate taxi speed depends on turn radius and surface condition..."

"...Normal taxi speed is approximately 20 knots, adjusted for conditions. On long straight taxi routes, speeds up to 30 knots are acceptable, however at speeds greater than 20 knots use caution when using the nose wheel steering wheel to avoid overcontrolling the nose wheels. When approaching a turn, speed should be slowed to an appropriate speed for conditions. On a dry surface, use approximately 10 knots for turn angles greater than those typically required for high speed runway turnoffs..."

"...If nose wheel “scrubbing” occurs while turning, reduce steering angle and/or taxi speed..."

ENGINE OUT TAXI (EOT)

As noted above, EOT operations may aggravate nose tire scrubbing damage. Turns in the direction of the running engine is running will also result in additional nose tire scrubbing and therefore should be avoided.

TIRE REJECTION CRITERIA

An 737 operator asked if tires with this damage need to be removed from the airplane. In response, we suggest that operators use the standard tire accept/reject criteria that is contained in AMM 32-45-00 to decide if tires are serviceable. If there are loose flaps of rubber, visible fabric, deep cuts, etc the tire should be removed. If the tire has visible abrasion but does not have any of the conditions contained in AMM 32-45-00, it is acceptable to leave the tire in service. Refer to the photos attached to this article for examples of tires with scrubbing damage.

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Flight Operations Technical Bulletin (FOTB)	737-08-1 Engine Out Taxi		

Related Categories

- Airplane Maintenance Issues : Issues that occur during airplane maintenance or have an impact on airplane reliability
- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability
- In Service Occurrences : null

Attachments:

a) Scrubbing examples

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